**Project Proposal | 6COSC023W Final Year Project**

# On-Chain Signal Analysis for Crypto Trading

Testing whether blockchain transaction data predicts price and volatility beyond what market data alone shows

Sadana Suresh | w21162895

Supervisor: Dr Georgy Urumov

2 November 2026

# Declaration

This project proposal has been prepared based on my own work. Where other published and unpublished source materials have been used, these have been acknowledged in references.

| Tool | Purpose | How it was used |
|---|---|---|
| Claude (Anthropic) | Source summarising | 11 reviewed sources were found and selected independently through Google Scholar and publisher pages. Due to the number of sources, AI was used to summarise their key findings. |
| Claude (Anthropic) | SPaG check + Structure framework | Proofreading (spelling, grammar, punctuation) and help structuring sentences |
| Claude (Anthropic) | Organising supervisor input | Asked to sort the resources listed in my supervisor's email into categories |
| Claude (Anthropic) | Explaining concepts | Asked to explain the statistical methods (e.g. walk-forward validation and the Diebold-Mariano test) so I could understand and apply them |

Background

# On-chain data may help traders, but the tools are expensive

**Retail crypto volume, Q1 2026**

## $979B

Retail transaction volume, down 11% from $1.1T a year earlier (TRM Labs, 2026)

**Cost of an enterprise tool**

## ~$50k-200k/yr

Chainalysis does not publish prices; one third-party estimate (CostBench, 2026)

**This project's data cost**

## $0/mo

Free tiers only (BigQuery, The Graph, CCXT)

**Stakeholders:** individual traders (the users), paid platforms like Nansen, Glassnode and Chainalysis, and the free data sources the project uses. This project tests whether this kind of information can be checked and given to an individual trader for free.

Problem and Motivation

# Chart-only traders may miss signals that appear before the price moves

Traders who rely only on price charts may miss a category of information that can appear before the price moves: on-chain activity. Some studies find that on-chain data helps forecast returns or market cycles (Chi, Chu and Hao, 2024; Grobys, Näsman and Sandretto, 2026), though the evidence is mixed.

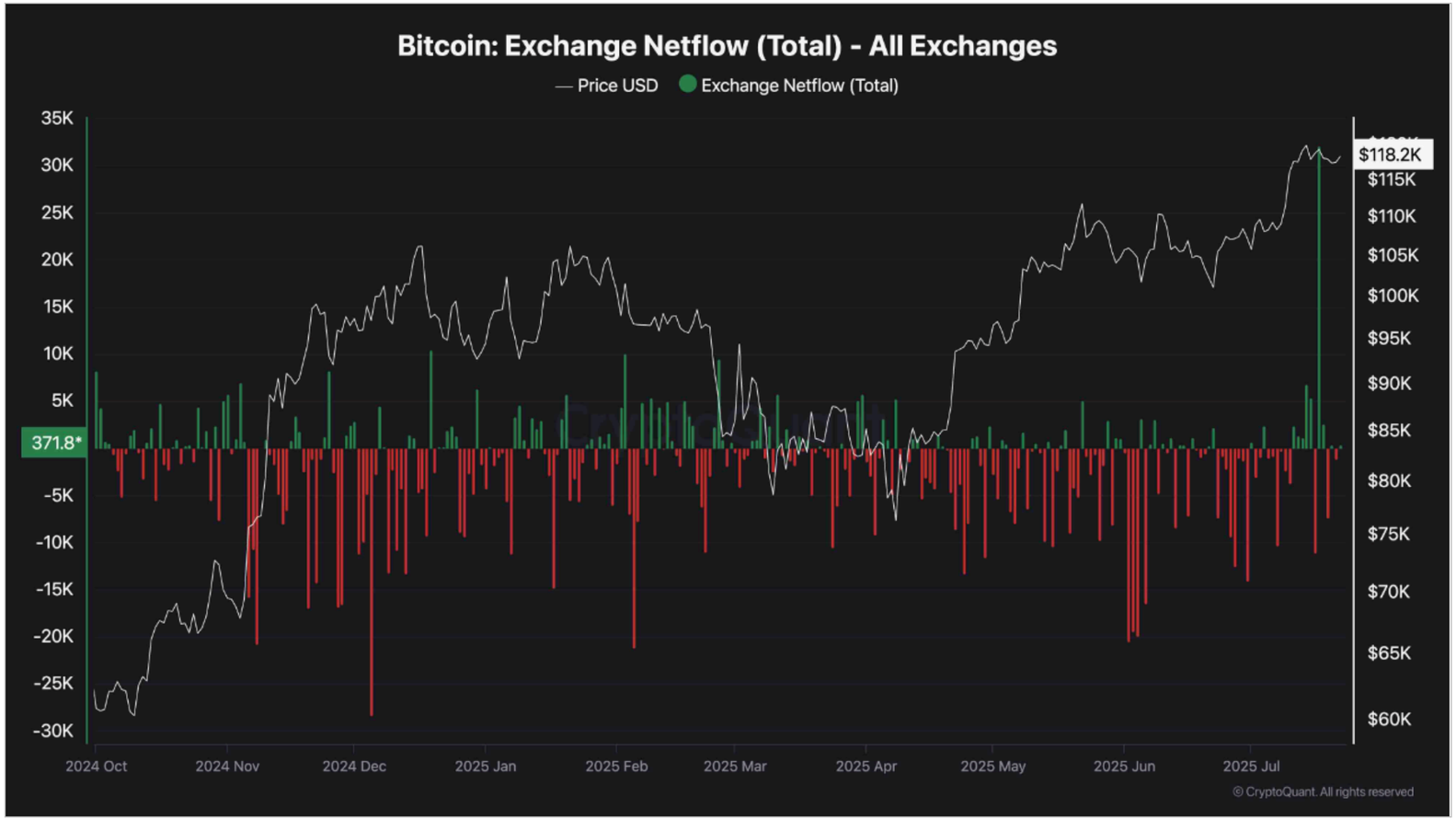
**Wallet moves funds to an exchange** → **Chart-only trader sees nothing yet** → **Price drops: they notice too late**

**The deeper problem:** platforms sell on-chain alerts without published out-of-sample tests, so a trader cannot tell a real signal from noise.

**This project asks: do on-chain signals carry predictive information beyond market data, and can a free tool give an individual trader this early visibility?**

The Idea

# The kind of signal this project tests: Bitcoin exchange flows vs price




Illustrative only: CryptoQuant data is not part of this project's pipeline, which builds the same net-flow measure from BigQuery and exchange wallet labels. Bars: daily net flow into (green) or out of (red) exchanges; line: price. Spikes like July 2025's have often come before corrections (Shayan Markets, 2025), but research is mixed: ETH inflows predict lower ETH returns, while BTC inflows mostly do not (Chi, Chu and Hao, 2024). Objective 4 tests whether these flows improve the forecast; Objective 5 measures how far ahead they appear.

Literature Review

# 11 sources: mixed evidence, and none combines all four signals

### Do signals predict price?

**Chi, Chu and Hao (2024)**: ETH and USDT flows predict returns at 1-6 hours; BTC flows mostly do not [Obj 4-5]

**Grobys, Näsman and Sandretto (2026)**: on-chain data predicts BTC cycles [Obj 6]

**Chalkiadakis et al. (2022)**: statistical causality, sentiment & price (single signal) [Obj 4]

### Signal data and regimes

**Drakopoulou (2026)**: stablecoin liquidity as a regime signal [Obj 2]

**Ante, Fiedler and Strehle (2021)**: stablecoin issuance and abnormal crypto returns [Obj 2]

**Zhu et al. (2024)**: what drives DEX liquidity on Uniswap [Obj 2]

**Urumov and Chountas (2022)**: fuzzy clustering for volatility (supervisor's paper) [regimes]

### Entities, methods, validation

**Kang et al. (2020)**: de-anonymisation via address clustering [Obj 2]

**Granger (1969)**: supporting causality test in Objective 4 [Obj 4]

**Bailey et al. (2016)**: backtest overfitting in finance [Obj 7]

**Harvey, Liu and Zhu (2016)**: multiple-testing bias in finance research [Obj 7]

**Gap: none of the reviewed studies combines all four signal types with this validation design**

Bailey et al. (2016) and Harvey, Liu and Zhu (2016) warn that testing many signals risks false discovery, hence walk-forward validation (Objective 7).

**Trend:** newer studies (2026) look at market cycles, while older ones test one signal at a time. Results change with the time horizon and the test used (Chi, Chu and Hao use hours; Drakopoulou uses days), so this project fixes its two targets, four lead-lag windows and walk-forward test in advance.

**Connections:** stablecoins have the most support across the reviewed studies (Chi, Chu and Hao, 2024; Ante, Fiedler and Strehle, 2021; Drakopoulou, 2026), so they are the signal most likely to pass Objective 4. Exchange flows need exchange labels, built with the same clustering that Kang et al. (2020) show can de-anonymise users, so signal accuracy and privacy risk are linked.

**Possible extension:** test each signal inside regimes found by fuzzy clustering (Urumov and Chountas, 2022).

Existing Solutions and Requirements

# Existing platforms offer on-chain analytics; this project tests four signals combined.

| Platform | Pricing | What it does | Gap it leaves |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nansen | Free, or Pro from $49/mo | Wallet labelling | No published predictive testing |
| Glassnode | Paid plans from $49/mo | Macro on-chain metrics | Predictive testing only in beta (Alpha Lab) |
| Arkham Intelligence | Free to browse; API needs approval | Entity labelling (planned label source) | No forecasting or signal testing in its documented features |
| Chainalysis | Quote-based (est. $50k-200k/yr) | Blockchain forensics (compliance) | Priced for institutions, not individuals |

## Requirements drawn from these gaps

**R1**
**Combine all 4 signals into one tested score**
none of the four platforms reviewed publishes one

**R2**
**Test each signal statistically, not just display it**
forecast tests and walk-forward validation

**R3**
**Keep data free**
free tiers only, so any individual can use it (SDG 10)

**R4**
**Show confidence ranges and hit rate, not buy/sell advice**
limits misuse and over-trust (SDG 10)

The project does not collect new data. It adds the testing that these platforms do not provide.

Sources: Nansen (2026), Glassnode (2026), Arkham Intelligence (2026a, 2026b), CostBench (2026).

Aim

# Develop a web dashboard for traders that surfaces on-chain signals across Bitcoin and Ethereum, to evaluate whether they predict price movement and volatility beyond market data alone.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Exchange inflows/outflows** | **Whale wallet transfers** | **Stablecoin flows** | **DEX liquidity activity** |

**Research question:** does each signal add predictive information beyond market data, and does combining all four beat the best single signal?

**Why it matters (SDG 10):** checking on-chain data should not need a large budget.

Objectives

# 7 SMART objectives, each with a pass or fail test

1. **20 Nov 2026** Pipeline for BTC/ETH (BigQuery, CCXT): 3 months of history at each source's finest resolution (5-minute for prices), under 5% missing intervals, plus a live feed (Alchemy/Infura, Mempool.space)
2. **8 Jan 2027** Collect the 4 signals via BigQuery, exchange wallet labels and The Graph: 7 series (3 per asset plus one market-wide stablecoin series) over the full history, plus cross-chain flows (Q7)
3. **8 Jan 2027** Rolling z-score anomaly detection: flag transfers over 2 standard deviations from that wallet/token's recent mean. Success: in the test weeks, flagged hours are followed by larger absolute next-hour returns than other hours (Mann-Whitney U, Holm over 2 tests)
4. **21 Jan 2027** Market-only model (past returns and trading volume) vs the same model plus each signal, on a walk-forward split. Success: lower out-of-sample RMSE for next-hour log returns and realised volatility (two pre-registered targets), significant on a Diebold-Mariano test after Holm correction; Granger is supporting evidence only
5. **21 Jan 2027** Lead-lag: correlation of each signal with later returns and volatility at 30min, 1hr, 4hr and 24hr. Success: the shortest window that is significant after Holm correction and holds out-of-sample is the lead time; otherwise no lead is claimed
6. **10 Mar 2027** Composite score of all 4 signals. Success: beats the best single signal (chosen on training data only) out-of-sample on a Diebold-Mariano test after Holm correction; otherwise a negative result
7. **10 Mar 2027** Walk-forward validation across objectives 3-6: expanding window, 9 weekly test folds scored as one pooled test. Success: a relationship counts as confirmed only if it holds out-of-sample

**Realistic:** each objective can be tested, simplified or dropped independently, within the module's 400-hour budget.

Scope

# What this project does and does not cover

## Included

- Data pipeline for Bitcoin and Ethereum (Objective 1)
- The 4 signal types and anomaly detection (Objectives 2-3), plus cross-exchange and cross-chain flows from BigQuery (Q7)
- Statistical tests: forecast comparison (Diebold-Mariano), lead-lag, composite score, walk-forward validation (Objectives 4-7)
- Everything delivered in one web dashboard

## Excluded

- Cryptocurrencies beyond Bitcoin and Ethereum (keeps 7 objectives achievable in the 400-hour budget)
- Live trading and profit claims (the project tests prediction; fees and slippage are not modelled)
- Claims beyond this sample (results hold for BTC and ETH over these 3 months only)
- A mobile app (web only, built with Streamlit)
- Any on-chain signals beyond the 4 chosen types (each extra signal adds its own data pipeline and tests)

System Overview

# From raw blockchain data to a tested dashboard

Sources
## Raw data

**BigQuery**
on-chain SQL history

**Arkham**
wallet labels, if approved

**The Graph**
DEX liquidity

**CCXT**
market prices

**Alchemy + Mempool.space**
live feed

→

Objective 1
## Pipeline

**Python + SQLite**
one stored dataset for BTC and ETH

**3 months history**
plus a live feed

→

Objective 2
## Four signals

**Exchange flows**

**Whale transfers**

**Stablecoin flows**

**DEX liquidity**

+ cross-chain flows (Q7), shown, not tested

→

Objectives 3-7
## Testing

**3 Anomaly flags**
rolling z-score

**4 Added value**
Baseline vs +signal

**5 Lead time**
signal vs later returns and volatility

**6 Composite**
4 signals combined

**7 Walk-forward**
out-of-sample

→

Output
## Dashboard

**Streamlit app**
BTC and ETH, free stack

**The Deliverable**

# What the dashboard will show a trader

- The 4 signals for Bitcoin and Ethereum, with unusual moves flagged and whether flagged hours were followed by bigger moves (Objective 3)
- Cross-exchange and cross-chain flows, shown as a description of where coins moved, never next to a p-value (Q7)
- A price chart with the flagged moves marked on it
- Whether each signal improves the forecast of returns and volatility beyond market data, with its p-value (Objective 4)
- The lead time of each signal, up to 24hr (Objective 5)
- A combined score with a range (Objective 6)
- The hit rate on unseen data, and a status: confirmed, not confirmed or negative result (Objective 7). Returns: share of test hours where the predicted direction (up or down) was right. Volatility has no direction, so it shows forecast error against the baseline instead

Methodology

# Agile (solo-adapted), with a success metric for each objective

**Why Agile:** each objective is tested independently, so any can be dropped without stalling the others; Waterfall would lock in the composite score before any signal is shown to work. **Limitation:** Agile assumes a team and flexible deadlines; this is a solo project with fixed module deadlines, so each sprint is tied to a phase date in the Time Schedule.

**Requirements elicited from:** supervisor consultation (14 research questions, feedback on data and tests) and the literature gap analysis (R1-R4).

| Objective | Method | Success metric | Limitation |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1-2 · Data and signals | BigQuery SQL and API pulls, stored in SQLite | Under 5% missing intervals | BigQuery lags the chain tip |
| 3 · Anomaly detection | Rolling z-score per wallet/token | Flagged hours have larger absolute next-hour returns: Mann-Whitney U (Mann and Whitney, 1947), Holm over 2 tests | z-scores assume bell-shaped data; crypto has fat tails, hence a rank-based test |
| 4 · Beyond-market test | Past returns and volume model vs same model plus signal; ADF test first; Granger as support | Lower out-of-sample RMSE (log returns, realised volatility); Diebold-Mariano $p < 0.05$ after Holm (16 tests) | Shows prediction, not cause |
| 5 · Lead-lag | Signal vs later returns and volatility at 4 windows | Shortest window significant after Holm (64 tests) | Linear only; depends on the windows chosen |
| 6 · Composite score | Equal-weight mix of the 4 z-scored signals, fixed in advance | Beats the best single signal (picked on training data); Diebold-Mariano after Holm (4 tests) | Equal weights may not be optimal; fitted weights only a side check |
| 7 · Walk-forward validation | Expanding window (4-week minimum), rolled weekly; no look-ahead | Pooled RMSE over 9 test weeks (about 1,500 hours) | Less data per test; 3 months may miss other market conditions |

**Original contribution:** the methods are standard, but no reviewed study tests all four signals together for Bitcoin and Ethereum with walk-forward validation.

Methodology in detail

# Test design: every rule is set before testing starts

| Part | Rule |
|---|---|
| Targets | Next-hour log return, and next-hour realised volatility (square root of the sum of squared 5-minute returns in that hour) |
| Anomaly test (Obj 3) | Flag transfers over 2 SD from the rolling mean; compare absolute next-hour returns after flagged vs other hours in the test weeks: Mann-Whitney U (Mann and Whitney, 1947), Holm over 2 tests |
| Baseline (Obj 4) | Market-only baseline: OLS on the target's own last 24 hourly values plus the last 24 hourly trading volumes (log), refitted in each training window (one fixed baseline, not every possible market model) |
| Signal model (Obj 4) | The same baseline, unchanged, plus one on-chain signal's last 24 hourly values |
| Decision (Obj 4) | Lower pooled out-of-sample RMSE, confirmed by a Diebold-Mariano test (Diebold and Mariano, 1995) with Holm correction over 16 tests (Holm, 1979) |
| Lead-lag (Obj 5) | Correlation with returns and volatility over the next 30min, 1hr, 4hr and 24hr; Newey-West errors, as overlapping windows are autocorrelated (Newey and West, 1987); Holm over 64 tests |
| Timing | A transfer counts in the hour its block is mined and is used only from the next hour; a daily signal uses its last completed day. For lead-lag, each window starts at the first 5-minute price bar after the block's timestamp |
| Composite (Obj 6) | Equal weights on z-scored signals, fixed in this proposal; fitted weights are a side check only. The best single signal is chosen on training data only, then both are compared on the same test weeks by Diebold-Mariano, with Holm over 4 tests (2 assets × 2 targets) |
| Q7 flows | Exchange labels and the bridge-contract list are fixed before any prices are looked at; the flows are descriptive only, kept out of the composite and never shown next to a p-value, so they add no tests |
| What a pass means | Predictive value for BTC and ETH in this 3-month sample only, not profit: fees and slippage are not modelled, so the dashboard reports hit rate, not returns |

Methodology in practice

# Walk-forward validation: expanding window, no look-ahead

**Walk-forward validation (expanding window)**

*Week of the 3-month sample*

| Fold | Train weeks | Test week | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1-4 | 5 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 2 | 1-5 | 6 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 3 | 1-6 | 7 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 4 | 1-7 | 8 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 5 | 1-8 | 9 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 6 | 1-9 | 10 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 7 | 1-10 | 11 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 8 | 1-11 | 12 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 9 | 1-12 | 13 | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

**Key**

Training weeks (model fitted here)

Test week (model fixed before this week)

Each fold keeps all earlier weeks (4-week minimum). 9 test weeks x 168 hours = about 1,500 out-of-sample hours, scored as one pooled RMSE.

- **Set-up:** 3 months (13 weeks); first test is week 5, then roll weekly: 9 test weeks (about 1,500 out-of-sample hours), scored as one pooled RMSE; per-week wins are a stability note only
- **No look-ahead:** scaling is fitted inside each training window, and each signal uses only data known at that hour
- **Why it matters:** it stops lucky results looking real (Bailey et al., 2016; Harvey, Liu and Zhu, 2016). Other studies use years of data (Chi, Chu and Hao, 2024; Drakopoulou, 2026), so a negative result here would not contradict them, and claims cover this 3-month sample only

Tools and Techniques

# A free data stack, with alternatives considered

| Need | Chosen | Why chosen over the alternative | Main risk |
|---|---|---|---|
| On-chain history (Obj 1-2) | **Google BigQuery public datasets** | Dune: free plan is view-only. Etherscan: lookups only, kept as secondary | Lags the chain tip; first 1 TiB/month free (Google Cloud, 2026) |
| Live feed (Obj 1) | **Alchemy / Infura (ETH), Mempool.space (BTC)** | BigQuery: lags the chain tip | Free-tier rate limits |
| Wallet labels (Obj 2) | **Arkham Intelligence** (API needs approval) | Nansen: free tier limited, Pro is paid. Whale Alert: no free history | Access not yet confirmed; fallback: exchange-published addresses |
| DEX liquidity (Obj 2) | **The Graph** | Alchemy raw pool events: same data, but contracts must be decoded by hand (kept as fallback) | Free query quota |
| Market prices (Obj 1) | **CCXT** | Direct exchange APIs: one integration each | Rate limits |
| Storage (Obj 1) | **Python, pandas, SQLite** | PostgreSQL needs a server; Firestore has free-tier read limits and no SQL joins | Will not scale to many users |
| Statistics (Obj 3-7) | **statsmodels, scipy** | statsmodels covers OLS, ADF, Granger and Newey-West; scipy covers Mann-Whitney. R would split the codebase | Granger needs stable series |
| Dashboard (output) | **Streamlit** | Flask: charts must be built by hand | Reruns on every click |

**Hardware:** a Mac laptop for coding and a Windows laptop for planning and writing; no GPU or paid cloud needed. **Development:** Python, VS Code, Git and GitHub. The dashboard runs locally and can be deployed online later if time allows. **Skills:** existing: Python, SQL, Git, Flask. To learn: BigQuery, The Graph queries, time-series testing (Diebold-Mariano, Newey-West) and Streamlit.

Data feasibility

# Where each signal comes from, and the fallback

| Data | Source | Resolution | Fallback if it fails |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Exchange flows** | BigQuery BTC and ETH tables, plus Arkham exchange labels (not yet confirmed) | Every block (BTC about 10 min, ETH 12 s) | Addresses exchanges publish, e.g. Binance (Quinn, 2022); main wallets only, so flows are partial |
| **Whale transfers** | BigQuery transfers, plus Arkham labels if approved | Every block | Size threshold only, without labels |
| **Stablecoin flows** | BigQuery Ethereum token transfers (USDT, USDC); one market-wide series, used for both BTC and ETH | Every block | Etherscan token-transfer lookups |
| **DEX liquidity** | The Graph (Uniswap subgraph): ETH pools, and WBTC pools for BTC | Hourly pool data | Alchemy: read pool events directly |
| **Cross-chain flows (Q7)** | BigQuery Ethereum transfers into and out of bridge contracts, and WBTC mints and burns | Every block | Etherscan lookups on the bridge contracts |
| **Prices (targets)** | CCXT (Binance) | 5-minute candles | Another exchange through CCXT |
| **Live feed** | Alchemy/Infura (ETH), Mempool.space (BTC) | Seconds | BigQuery, accepting its lag |

**Checked 13 Oct 2026 (free sandbox):** a test query on the BigQuery Bitcoin and Ethereum tables found them up to date, with the newest blocks about 30 min (BTC) and 1 min (ETH) behind the live chain. A 3-month pull of Ethereum token transfers would scan 47 GB, under 5% of the free 1 TiB a month.

**Not yet confirmed:** Arkham's API needs access approved by Arkham, and its terms limit how its data is used and shared (Arkham Intelligence, 2026a), so label access and terms are checked in week 1 before any labels are stored.

**Go/no-go:** every source is tested in week 1 of the pipeline phase; a signal whose source still fails is dropped and reported, and the other signals continue (Objective 2).

Ethics, Legal, Social, EDI and Sustainability

# Key risks and safeguards

| Area | Issue | Safeguard |
|---|---|---|
| Legal | Each source has its own terms; Arkham bans scraping and republishing its data | Follow each API's terms: approved access only (Computer Misuse Act 1990), no republishing (Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988) |
| Privacy (UK GDPR, Data Protection Act 2018) | Wallet addresses may count as "online identifiers"; clustering could link them to people | Only public entity labels (exchanges, funds), never individuals; no de-anonymisation |
| Data handling | Stored data could outlive its purpose | Public data only; backed up to University OneDrive; raw data kept off GitHub and deleted after final marks |
| Social and financial harm | Predictions misread as advice; crowd use could amplify volatility | Disclaimer, plus hit rate, range and status on every output; no buy or sell signals |
| EDI | Stablecoin users in unstable economies are often non-experts | Plain-language labels; no "get rich" marketing |
| Data and result quality | Data gaps, mislabelled wallets, false positives | Under 5% missing data; walk-forward validation; negative results reported |
| Sustainability | Cloud queries and model re-runs use energy (no mining or transactions) | Store data locally; filter BigQuery scans by date and column |

**Main goal, SDG 10 (target 10.2):** the project runs on free data and a normal laptop, so it costs $0, compared with an estimated $50k-200k a year for enterprise tools (R3). Every output shows its hit rate, so users can judge how far to trust it (R4).

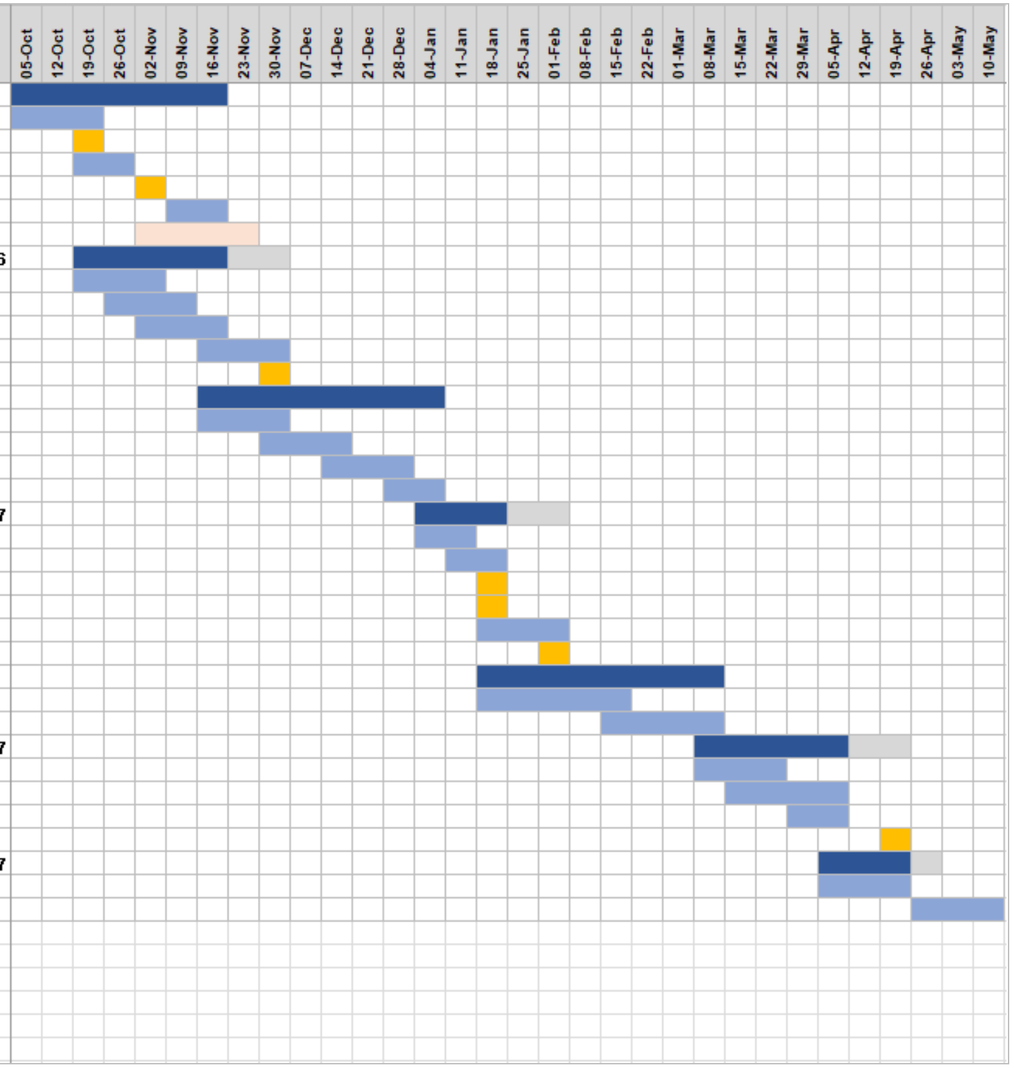
**Supporting, SDG 8 (target 8.2, innovation):** free analytics built on public blockchain data.

**Limit:** SDG 8.10 is about access to financial services; this widens access to analysis only. About 1.3 billion adults had no account in 2024 (Klapper et al., 2025).

Time Schedule

# A ~2-week buffer ahead of every summative submission

| Task | Start | End | Buffer to |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 PP finalisation | 05/10/26 | 19/11/26 | |
| 1.1 Draft slides and supervisor review | 05/10/26 | 21/10/26 | |
| 1.2 Formative draft submitted | 22/10/26 | 22/10/26 | |
| 1.3 Supervisor corrections, ethics declaration | 23/10/26 | 01/11/26 | |
| 1.4 PP submission (slides + ethics form) | 02/11/26 | 02/11/26 | |
| 1.5 Live presentation window (requested online) | 09/11/26 | 19/11/26 | |
| Away 2–23 Nov | 02/11/26 | 23/11/26 | |
| 2 Data pipeline | 21/10/26 | 20/11/26 | 04/12/26 |
| 2.1 BigQuery queries (date- and column-filtered) | 21/10/26 | 03/11/26 | |
| 2.2 Live feed: Alchemy/Infura (ETH), Mempool.space (BTC) | 28/10/26 | 10/11/26 | |
| 2.3 CCXT prices, SQLite schema, 3-month backfill | 04/11/26 | 20/11/26 | |
| 2.4 Systems Requirement Specification (SRS) | 21/11/26 | 03/12/26 | |
| 2.5 SRS deadline | 04/12/26 | 04/12/26 | |
| 3 Signals + anomaly detection | 21/11/26 | 08/01/27 | |
| 3.1 Exchange flows (label go/no-go check) | 21/11/26 | 04/12/26 | |
| 3.2 Whale transfers (Arkham labels if approved) | 05/12/26 | 18/12/26 | |
| 3.3 Stablecoin flows (BigQuery) and DEX liquidity (The Graph) | 19/12/26 | 01/01/27 | |
| 3.4 Rolling z-score anomaly detection | 02/01/27 | 08/01/27 | |
| 4 Statistical testing + MVP | 09/01/27 | 21/01/27 | 04/02/27 |
| 4.1 Baseline vs baseline + signal, Diebold-Mariano, Holm (16 tests) | 09/01/27 | 15/01/27 | |
| 4.2 Lead-lag at 30min, 1hr, 4hr, 24hr (64 tests) | 13/01/27 | 21/01/27 | |
| 4.3 First code demo | 22/01/27 | 22/01/27 | |
| 4.4 Ethics declaration accepted (required by IPD) | 22/01/27 | 22/01/27 | |
| 4.5 IPD pack (slides, prototype, video) | 23/01/27 | 03/02/27 | |
| 4.6 IPD deadline | 04/02/27 | 04/02/27 | |
| 5 Composite score + validation | 22/01/27 | 10/03/27 | |
| 5.1 Composite score (fixed equal weights), Holm (4 tests) | 22/01/27 | 15/02/27 | |
| 5.2 Expanding walk-forward, 9 test weeks, pooled RMSE | 16/02/27 | 10/03/27 | |
| 6 Full dashboard + report | 11/03/27 | 08/04/27 | 22/04/27 |
| 6.1 Polish dashboard UI | 11/03/27 | 24/03/27 | |
| 6.2 Write report (methods, results, reflection) | 18/03/27 | 08/04/27 | |
| 6.3 Record demo video | 01/04/27 | 08/04/27 | |
| 6.4 Final submission (report, code, video) | 22/04/27 | 22/04/27 | |
| 7 Viva prep | 09/04/27 | 20/04/27 | 28/04/27 |
| 7.1 Mock Q&A across all 7 objectives | 09/04/27 | 20/04/27 | |
| 7.2 Viva window | 29/04/27 | 14/05/27 | |
| | | | |
| Phase | | | |
| Task | | | |
| Buffer before deadline | | | |
| Milestone / deadline | | | |
| Away (talk requested online) | | | |




Official deadlines: PP 2 Nov, SRS 4 Dec, first code demo 22 Jan, IPD 4 Feb, final report/code/video 22 Apr, viva 29 Apr-14 May.

Time Schedule detail

# Seven phases, each with a scored risk and a fix

## 1 PP finalisation

Draft 22 Oct (formative); deadline 2 Nov: slides and ethics form; talk 9-19 Nov

**Risk (5×2 = 10, medium):** Away 2-23 Nov, during the talk window

**Fix:** Talk requested online; rehearsal done before leaving

## 2 Data pipeline

Target 20 Nov: BigQuery, live APIs, SQLite, 3-month backfill; SRS by 4 Dec

**Risk (2×4 = 8, medium):** BigQuery 1 TiB free quota and rate limits

**Fix:** Go/no-go check of each source in week 1; filter scans by date and column; coarser data if needed

## 3 Signals + anomaly detection

Target 8 Jan: 4 signals and Q7 flows, rolling z-score flags and their Mann-Whitney check

**Risk (4×3 = 12, medium):** Arkham access refused, or labels harder than expected

**Fix:** Exchange-published addresses; if a signal is still unusable after 2 weeks, drop it and report on three

## 4 Statistical testing + MVP

Target 21 Jan: forecast tests, lead-lag, first dashboard; IPD pack by 4 Feb, with the ethics declaration accepted by then. Needs phases 2 and 3

**Risk (4×2 = 8, medium):** No significant result

**Fix:** Report as a negative result; show behaviour descriptively

## 5 Composite score + validation

Target 10 Mar: composite (fixed equal weights), walk-forward test. Needs phase 4

**Risk (2×2 = 4, low):** Backtesting compute time

**Fix:** Start simple before optimising

## 6 Full dashboard + report

Deadline 22 Apr: polish UI, write results, demo video

**Risk (3×4 = 12, medium):** Report-writing crunch

**Fix:** Draft each section as its objective completes

## 7 Viva prep

Before 29 Apr: mock Q&A across all 7 objectives

**Risk (3×4 = 12, medium):** Statistics questions that are hard to answer

**Fix:** Mock Q&A with supervisor feedback; ~1-week buffer

**Risk scoring:** probability × impact, each 1-5 (15+ high, 6-14 medium, under 6 low). **Strategy:** ~2-week buffers before summative submissions; risks reviewed at each supervisor meeting.

**Reflection:** a short log after each phase, reused in the final report.

## References (Harvard style), 1 of 2


- Ante, L., Fiedler, I. and Strehle, E. (2021) 'The influence of stablecoin issuances on cryptocurrency markets', *Finance Research Letters*, 41, Article 101867. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.frl.2020.101867.
- Arkham Intelligence (2026a) *API terms of service*. Available at: https://arkm.com/api-terms-of-service (Accessed: 15 October 2026).
- Arkham Intelligence (2026b) 'The Intelligence Platform', *Arkham Codex*. Available at: https://codex.arkm.com/the-intelligence-platform (Accessed: 13 October 2026).
- Bailey, D.H., Borwein, J.M., Salehipour, A., López de Prado, M. and Zhu, Q. (2016) *Backtest overfitting in financial markets*. [Working paper]. Available at: https://davidhbailey.com/dhbpapers/overfit-tools-at.pdf (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Chalkiadakis, I., Zaremba, A., Peters, G.W. and Chantler, M.J. (2022) 'On-chain analytics for sentiment-driven statistical causality in cryptocurrencies', *Blockchain: Research and Applications*, 3(2), Article 100063. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bcra.2022.100063.
- Chi, Y., Chu, Q. and Hao, W. (2024) *Return and volatility forecasting using on-chain flows in cryptocurrency markets*. [Preprint]. arXiv:2411.06327. Available at: https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.06327 (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Computer Misuse Act 1990, c. 18. Available at: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1990/18/contents (Accessed: 26 October 2026).
- Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988, c. 48. Available at: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1988/48/contents (Accessed: 26 October 2026).
- CostBench (2026) *All Chainalysis plans & pricing*. Available at: https://www.costbench.com/software/crypto-compliance/chainalysis/ (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Data Protection Act 2018, c. 12. Available at: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2018/12/contents (Accessed: 26 October 2026).
- Diebold, F.X. and Mariano, R.S. (1995) 'Comparing predictive accuracy', *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*, 13(3), pp. 253-263. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1080/07350015.1995.10524599.
- Drakopoulou, V. (2026) *Stablecoin liquidity as a crypto-native regime signal: state-dependent density forecasts for BTC, ETH, and SOL*. [Preprint]. Research Square. Available at: https://doi.org/10.21203/rs.3.rs-9715935/v1 (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Glassnode (2026) *Plans & pricing*. Available at: https://studio.glassnode.com/pricing (Accessed: 12 October 2026).
- Google Cloud (2026) *BigQuery pricing*. Available at: https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/pricing (Accessed: 13 October 2026).
- Granger, C.W.J. (1969) 'Investigating causal relations by econometric models and cross-spectral methods', *Econometrica*, 37(3), pp. 424-438. Available at: https://ideas.repec.org/a/ecm/emetrp/v37y1969i3p424-38.html (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Grobys, K., Näsman, S. and Sandretto, D. (2026) 'Using on-chain data to predict Bitcoin cycles', *Research in International Business and Finance*, 89, Article 103486. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ribaf.2026.103486.

## References (Harvard style), 2 of 2


- Harvey, C.R., Liu, Y. and Zhu, H. (2016) '... and the cross-section of expected returns', *The Review of Financial Studies*, 29(1), pp. 5-68. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1093/rfs/hhv059.
- Holm, S. (1979) 'A simple sequentially rejective multiple test procedure', *Scandinavian Journal of Statistics*, 6(2), pp. 65-70. Available at: https://www.jstor.org/stable/4615733 (Accessed: 13 October 2026).
- Kang, C., Lee, C., Ko, K., Woo, J. and Hong, J.W.K. (2020) 'De-anonymization of the Bitcoin network using address clustering', in Zheng, Z. et al. (eds.) *Blockchain and Trustworthy Systems: BlockSys 2020*, CCIS vol. 1267. Singapore: Springer, pp. 489-501. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-15-9213-3_38.
- Klapper, L., Singer, D., Starita, L. and Norris, A. (2025) *The Global Findex Database 2025: Connectivity and Financial Inclusion in the Digital Economy*. Washington, DC: World Bank. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1596/978-1-4648-2204-9.
- Mann, H.B. and Whitney, D.R. (1947) 'On a test of whether one of two random variables is stochastically larger than the other', *The Annals of Mathematical Statistics*, 18, pp. 50-60. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1214/aoms/1177730491.
- Nansen (2026) 'About Nansen Pro', *Nansen Academy*. Available at: https://academy.nansen.ai/articles/9412804-about-nansen-pro (Accessed: 12 October 2026).
- Newey, W.K. and West, K.D. (1987) 'A simple, positive semi-definite, heteroskedasticity and autocorrelation consistent covariance matrix', *Econometrica*, 55(3), pp. 703-708. Available at: https://ideas.repec.org/a/ecm/emetrp/v55y1987i3p703-08.html (Accessed: 13 October 2026).
- Quinn, C. (2022) 'Binance publishes wallet addresses, details of current holdings', *The Block*, 10 November. Available at: https://www.theblock.co/post/185230/security (Accessed: 15 October 2026).
- Shayan Markets (2025) 'Bitcoin price analysis: key factors point to a BTC correction ahead' [chart: CryptoQuant data], *CryptoPotato*, 22 July. Available at: https://cryptopotato.com/bitcoin-price-analysis-key-factors-point-to-a-btc-correction-ahead/ (Accessed: 13 October 2026).
- TRM Labs (2026) *Q1 2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index*. Available at: https://trmlabs.com/resources/blog/q1-2026-global-crypto-adoption-index (Accessed: 10 October 2026).
- Urumov, G. and Chountas, P. (2022) 'Clustering stock price volatility using intuitionistic fuzzy sets', *Notes on Intuitionistic Fuzzy Sets*, 28(3), pp. 343-352. Available at: https://doi.org/10.7546/nifs.2022.28.3.343-352.
- Zhu, B., Liu, D., Wan, X., Liao, G., Moallemi, C. and Bachu, B. (2024) *What drives liquidity on decentralized exchanges? Evidence from the Uniswap protocol*. [Preprint]. arXiv:2410.19107. Available at: https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.19107 (Accessed: 10 October 2026).


28 sources: 15 academic (the 11 reviewed on the Literature slide, plus Diebold and Mariano, 1995, Holm, 1979, Mann and Whitney, 1947, and Newey and West, 1987, for the tests), 10 industry or institutional (TRM Labs, CostBench, CryptoPotato, The Block, Nansen, Glassnode, Arkham Intelligence (two pages), Google Cloud, World Bank Findex) and 3 UK Acts (Computer Misuse Act 1990; Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988; Data Protection Act 2018).